Talyah Pierce

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EDUCATION

University of Pennsylvania Weitzman School of Design— Master of City Planning — **Philadelphia, Pennsylvania**
May 2027

University of Pennsylvania — Bachelor of Arts in Urban Studies, minor in Data Science — **Philadelphia, Pennsylvania**
Summa Cum Laude — May 2026

AWARDS AND HONORS

Urban Studies Honors Designation — Spring 2026
Thesis "Transit, Turnout, and Inequality: The Intersection of Transit and Poverty in Philadelphia Elections" selected by faculty for exceptional methodological rigor, coherence, and theoretical contributions to the field of urban studies.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Reinvestment Fund — **Philadelphia, Pennsylvania**
Policy Solutions Intern — Summer 2026/ Spring 2027

- Conducted GIS- and SQL-based quantitative analysis of housing and community development trends to inform policy recommendations for nonprofit and government clients.
- Cleaned large municipal datasets in SQL and applied k-means clustering methods to implement market value analyses.

Penn Development Research Initiative — **Philadelphia, Pennsylvania**
Research Fellow — Summer 2025 / Spring 2026

- Performed comparative cost analyses of land administration systems to evaluate implications for property valuation, development efficiency, and municipal revenue capacity for World Bank-sponsored projects.
- Developed R-based web scraping and LLM-automated workflows to collect and structure data across systems.

Penn Program on Opinion Research and Election Studies — **Philadelphia, Pennsylvania**
Research Fellow — Summer 2024/Spring 2026

- Analyzed 4,000+ informal surveys in Liberia to assess predictors of market formalization, examining vendor welfare, financial access, and political behavior.
- Supported NBC Decision Desk analysts with precinct-level election monitoring in Wisconsin on Election Night.
- Tutored undergraduates in introductory to intermediate-level coding, statistics, and survey methods courses.

Centennial Parkside Community Development Corporation — **Philadelphia, Pennsylvania**
Intern — Spring 2024

- Produced GIS-based reports on environmental and public health conditions to inform neighborhood investment and programming priorities in East Parkside, Philadelphia.

Crime and Justice Policy Lab — **Philadelphia, Pennsylvania**
Research Assistant — Summer 2023

- Led independent quantitative research project investigating how litter impacts rates of gun violence in Philadelphia from 2017-2019 through the Penn Undergraduate Research Mentoring Program.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Software Skills: R, ArcGIS, SQL, Python, Excel, LaTeX, Adobe Illustrator, Adobe InDesign
Languages: Spanish (intermediate)
Coursework: Introduction to Property Development, Public Policy Analytics, Statistical and Data Mining Methods for Urban Data Analysis, Introduction to GIS, Inferential Statistics, Microeconomics/Macroeconomics, Applied Data Science

ACTIVITIES

Extracurricular Activities: Project 26 fellow, Chi Omega sorority, PennDems
Interests: volleyball, crossword puzzles, guitar